

Unit 12 Helicopter Rescue

Read & Listen

Exercise 1

Preparations for helicopter rescue

A) On Board Ship

1. All loose **<gear>** must be taken down and secured.
2. The vessel must **<maintain>** a **<steady>** course and **<constant>** speed.
3. It is important to give clear instructions to the crew - to **<brief>** them.
4. Voice **<communication>** will be impossible because of the noise from helicopter engines and **<rotor-blades>**.
5. **<Visibility>** will be poor; the air will be white with **<spray>**.
6. If it is dark outside the Captain may give orders to direct the ship's **<spotlights>** towards the deck.
7. It is important that the light does not **<blind>** the helicopter pilot who must have a good view of the **<pick-up>** area.

Exercise 2

Preparations for helicopter rescue

B) The Patient

1. First of all, give the patient **<first-aid>**!
2. Put on a **<life-jacket>**.
3. If necessary, give him **<pain-relievers|pain-killers>** if he is experiencing pain.
4. **<Tag>** the information about his **<medication>** on his person.
5. If he is in foreign waters, his **<seaman's book>** must also be sent with him.
6. Prepare him for hoisting by placing him on the **<stretcher>** that the helicopter **<rescue man>** provides on arrival.

Exercise 3

a spotlight	a strong light that can be pointed in different directions
rotor-blades	the rotating propeller on a helicopter
a pick-up-area	the spot from which hoisting takes place
a winch	a machine with a thick chain used for lifting heavy things
medication	medicines given to a patient
to illuminate	to light
to hoist	to raise by rope or machine
to brief	to give instructions or information
a seaman's book	a seaman's passport

essential	extremely important
pain-relievers	pain-killers
preparation	getting ready
rigging	system of ropes and chains to support masts and cranes
the scene-of-accident	the place where an accident has happened
to blind	to direct strong light towards eyes
to tag	to attach a small label or document
a life-jacket	equipment to help you float

Exercise 4

1. The **survivors** from the grounded ship swam ashore but were **stranded** on the island until the helicopter arrived.
2. The wind was very strong with violent **gusts**.
3. The crew were dressed in **rescue suits** when they were **picked** up by helicopter from the **rescue raft**.
4. The winch **cable** broke during the rescue operation and hit the winch **operator** in the face, although he was not seriously **injured**.
5. The helicopter's **rotor-blades** were very near to touching the ship's rigging.
6. The fishing-boat had a heavy list and was in danger of **capsizing**.
7. The rescue man was **lowered** down to the ship, which was **rolling** heavily in the rough sea.
8. The waves had white **crests** and rose to a **height** of 4 metres.
9. Soon after **take-off** the helicopter had engine trouble and had to make an **emergency** landing at the nearest **airfield**.

10. There were some strained moments for the helicopter pilot in the **cockpit**.
11. The pilot wanted to know the relative **wind direction** and speed at the ship's port bow.
12. During a helicopter rescue operation the **guide rope** must not be secured to the ship.
13. The injured crew member was put on a **stretcher** and then hoisted up into the helicopter.
14. The helicopter usually **approaches** the ship from the stern on the port side and takes up a **hovering** position, from which it has a good **view** of the ship.